TEACHING DEMONSTRATION · ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Exploring Unique Marketing *Issues.*

What entrepreneurs face now that generative AI answers the search.

Understanding **Generative Engine Optimisation (GEO)** through foundational marketing: STP, brand, the marketing mix, and closing the deal with the sales steps.

LECTURER

Abdulla Muiz Fuad

Associate Lecturer Candidate

DATE

5 November 2026

A3, Central Administration

Found, chosen, booked.



THE CASE

Meet *Ruka Maldives*

- **Dhiffushi,** North Malé Atoll · 12 rooms · opened 2025
- **Cosy boutique,** boho style, a personal island-villa feel
- **Open-courtyard** and indoor dining · serviced living
- **Budget-friendly,** and no website of its own

Four questions every new venture must answer:

01 — STP

Who are our customers, and how do we find them?

Segment the market, choose targets, state one clear position.

Canvas: Customer Segments + Value Proposition

02 — BRAND

Why us? How does a brand decide whether AI finds you?

A consistent brand earns trust despite the liability of newness.

Canvas: Value Proposition

03 — 4PS → 7PS

What do we offer, and how?

The 4Ps become 7Ps, because a guesthouse sells a service.

Canvas: Channels + Revenue Streams

04 — SALES

Closing the deal: can selling be a repeatable system?

No one can guarantee a sale; the seven-step process makes it repeatable.

Canvas: Customer Relationships

Barringer & Ireland, “Unique Marketing Issues”: written for new ventures facing the liability of newness

abdullamuizfuad.github.io/GEO-Visibility-/demo

YOUR TURN

Be the *traveller.*

01 Scan the code with your camera

02 Pick a traveller: Couple, Solo, Family or Dive

03 Tap Search and read the AI's answer

04 Watch the screen

Pause at the question: "Why do you think the AI left Ruka out?"

SIMULATION · MODELLED ON OUR FIELD TEST, 4 NOV 2026

Same question, two languages. *Who gets chosen?*

cosy guesthouse near Malé for a honeymoon, not too expensive **Search**

AI assistant · English

cosy guesthouse near Malé for a honeymoon, not too expensive

Here are three cosy picks near Malé:

1. **Stone Hotels Dhiffushi**
   Dhiffushi · rooftop infinity pool, spa, private beach
2. **Arena Beach Hotel**
   Maafushi · private beach, 50 rooms
3. **Crystal Sands**

我们是情侣，想找马尔代夫马累附近温馨又不太贵的民宿 **Search**

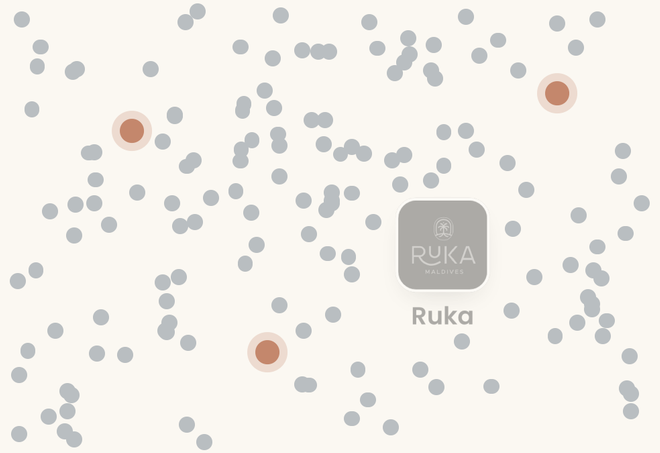
AI assistant · 中文

我们是情侣，想找马尔代夫马累附近温馨又不太贵的民宿

为您推荐以下三家：

1. **Arena Beach Hotel**
   Maafushi · private beach, 50 rooms
2. **Crystal Sands**
3. **Stone Hotels Dhiffushi**
   Dhiffushi · rooftop infinity pool, spa, private beach

PLACES TO STAY NEAR MALÉ — ~150 · illustrative



0 times **Ruka Maldives** was named



Real answers, 4 Nov 2026 · Gemini · Google AI Mode · Baidu

OBJECTIVE ONE · SEGMENT

Who *could* stay?

Segmentation divides a market into groups of customers with similar needs.

Barringer & Ireland, Unique Marketing Issues

DEMOGRAPHIC	Age, income, life stage: honeymooners, young families
GEOGRAPHIC	Where guests come from: Europe, China, South Asia
PSYCHOGRAPHIC	Lifestyle and values: boho aesthetic versus luxury resort
BEHAVIOURAL	Benefit sought: a budget stay versus diving every day

FOUR SEGMENTS NEAR MALÉ

Couples & honeymooners

Romance, privacy and a special setting

Solo travellers

Quiet, safety and value for money

Small families

Space, easy meals and a budget that works

Divers

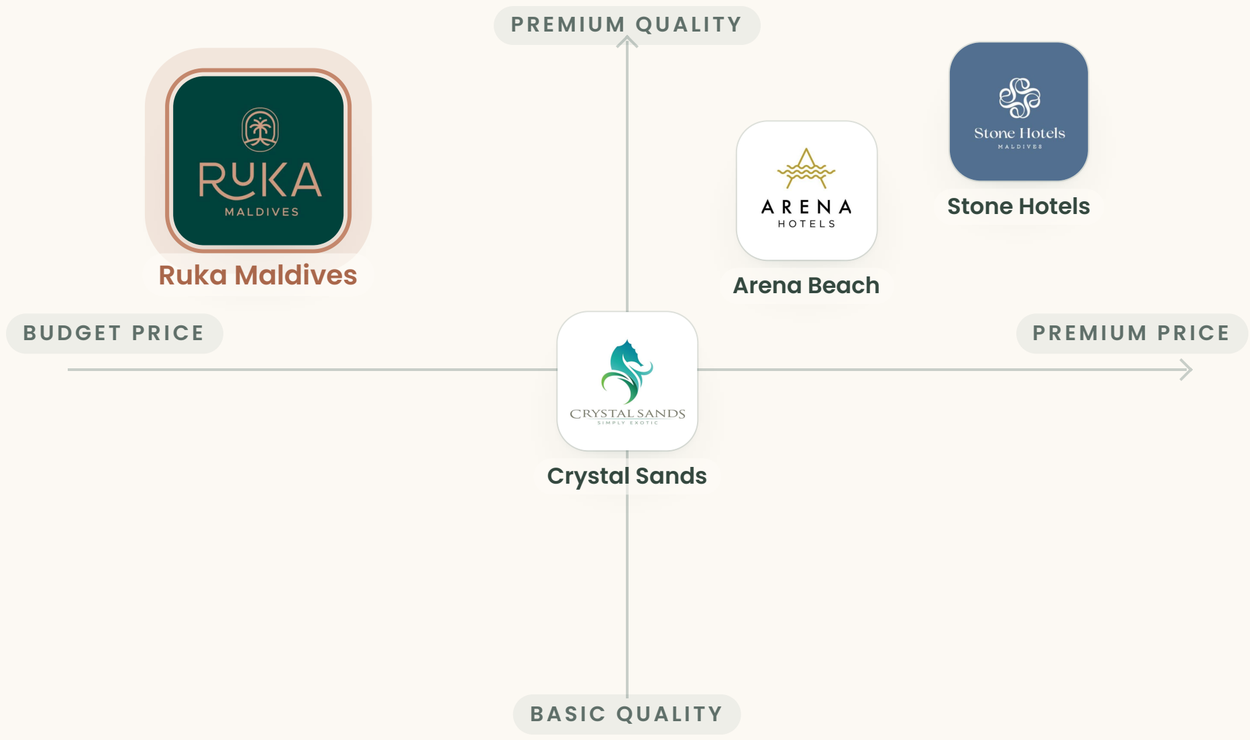
A dive centre on site and daily dive trips

TARGET · POSITION

Target where you can *win*

Choose the segments where a new venture has a **real advantage**; do not chase everyone.

- **Couples & honeymooners**
- **Solo travellers**
- **Small families**
- ~~**Divers: left out**~~
  Reveries Diving Village has a dive centre on site



Lecturer's perception, illustrative.

RUKA'S CORE POSITION

"A cosy boutique home-away-from-home on Dhiffushi"

Perceptual map: price × quality of experience

AI LENS

How an AI matches a prompt to a *position*

01

Reads the intent

"cosy, budget, honeymoon"

02

Checks the facts

Consistent, verifiable facts across sources

Listings · Maps · Reviews · Social

03

Shortlists

Only what it can verify and repeat

A POSITION IS PROVABLE WHEN…

- ✓ The **same facts** appear everywhere
- ✓ **Specific attributes** replace adjectives
- ✓ **Reviews echo** the position

ONE BRAND, THREE PROOF POINTS

Couples: intimate boho style and courtyard dining

Solo: privacy and serviced living on a budget

Families: villa-style living, indoor and courtyard dining

Morand & Schegg (2026), *Be Visible to AI*, HES-SO Valais-Wallis (practitioner white paper)

OBJECTIVE TWO · BRAND

A brand is a promise people, *and AI,* recognise

> "A brand is the set of attributes, positive or negative, that people associate with a company."
>
> *Barringer & Ireland, Unique Marketing Issues*

Liability of newness
No track record, so the brand must create trust

Difference
Stands out from look-alike guesthouses

Brand equity
Consistent signals add up to value and loyalty

Recognition
People and AI recommend what they can identify

TEACHING SCENARIO

EVERYWHERE

Ruka Maldives

Same name · same address · same phone

Every review and booking now counts for one brand, one entity an AI can recognise.

Name · Address · Phone, identical everywhere

The marketing mix in the *generative* era

STANDARD GEO VERSION

P1 Product GEO

Facts, not adjectives: 12 boho rooms, courtyard dining, breakfast included. AI repeats what it can check.

P2 Price GEO

Publish a range and terms, so AI can qualify the guest before it recommends.

P3 Place GEO

AI assistants are the newest intermediary: keep every listing consistent.

P4 Promotion GEO

Structured content and reviews that AI can extract and summarise.

+ SERVICE PS · BOOMS & BITNER (1981)

P5 People

Hosts named and reviewed consistently.

P6 Process

Clear booking and response steps an AI can describe.

P7 Physical evidence

Real photos of the boho rooms and courtyard, the same on every listing.

OBJECTIVE FOUR · CLOSING THE DEAL

AI opens doors; *you* close the sale

AI DOES THIS TODAY

1

Prospect for leads

Find travellers looking for a Dhiffushi stay

2

Initial contact

The first answer to an enquiry

3

Qualify the lead

Budget, dates and fit confirmed

4

Sales presentation

Rooms, courtyard and breakfast shown

HUMAN

5

Meet objections

"Can you arrange a courtyard dinner for our anniversary?"

6

Close the sale

Deposit and confirmation

7

Follow-up

Reviews, repeat stays, referrals

Steps one to four: the AI finds, filters and presents for you. A guest who clicks through arrives pre-qualified.

Steps five to seven: objections, the close and the relationship still belong to the guesthouse.

No one can guarantee a sale; a process makes it repeatable.

• DISCUSSION

If AI handles steps one to four, how does the guesthouse manager's role change?

Turn to your neighbour. Which touchpoints should stay human, and which can be automated?

01

Administrative responder → experience architect: less time on repeat enquiries, more on designing the stay.

02

Passive marketer → data curator: keeping Ruka's digital facts accurate everywhere.

Keep the demo open

YOUR TURN

Now, make Ruka *visible.*

BRAND	One name, address and phone everywhere
PRODUCT	Facts: boho style, courtyard dining, serviced living
PRICE	A clear price range and terms, published
PLACE	Bookable direct and on OTAs, details identical

Now tap Search again.

TRAVELLER: A COUPLE / HONEYMOON

1. *Ruka Maldives*
2. Stone Hotels Dhiffushi
3. Arena Beach Hotel

- **Solo & family:** Ruka moves up the list
- **Dive:** still not a fit; Reveries wins

Picked the dive couple? Reveries still wins. Positioning means choosing.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

Questions for *discussion* in class

01 *Ruka targets three segments. Is that one position or three? Use Barringer & Ireland to argue.*

STP · POSITIONING

02 *Which of the 7Ps would you fix first for Ruka to be found by AI, and why?*

MARKETING MIX · GEO

03 *Which steps of the sales process should a guesthouse never hand to AI?*

SEVEN-STEP SALES

TUTORIAL ACTIVITY

Groups of 3–4 · 30 minutes

01 Pick a real Maldivian guesthouse

02 Ask two AI assistants the same traveller prompt, in English and another language

03 Record who is named, and why

04 Map the property on a positioning map

GROUP ASSIGNMENT

"Conduct an AI visibility audit of a Maldivian guesthouse and propose a GEO-ready marketing plan."

1 · Audit
AI tools, Google Maps, Booking.com, social

2 · Segment & position
STP + positioning map

3 · Business Model Canvas
Map the venture

4 · 7Ps fixes
Each P, with GEO

5 · Sales plan
The seven steps

6 · Pitch
Ten minutes

Diagnosis **30** | Strategy **50** | Pitch **20**

Each task tests the four questions from slide 2

Ruka can be...

Found

BY THE MASSES

Consistent, verifiable facts that AI can repeat

Chosen

BY THE RIGHT AUDIENCE

A clear position, with proof points for couples, solo travellers and families

Booked

BY CUSTOMERS WHO BENEFIT THE BUSINESS

AI opens the door; people close the sale and retain the guest

Four lessons: STP chooses who · Brand earns trust · 7Ps make it verifiable · Sales steps close and retain

MY TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

Ready for the *manager's question.*

I came from industry. In marketing management roles I sat on the other side of the desk, interviewing graduates. The knowledge was there, but when a real question came there was no reference point, and minds went blank. So I teach students to meet that manager, and surprise them.

Abdulla Muiz Fuad

Questions?

01 **Real local cases**
Maldivian firms like Ruka, not distant examples

02 **Theory → application**
Every concept ends in a decision for a real business

03 **Practise the hard question**
Rehearse the manager's question until the answer comes

*Theory **and** application are worth more to an employer than academia or experience alone.*

References & *sources*

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Ruka Maldives is used with the owner's permission. Competitors are described only with publicly listed facts; the positioning map is the lecturer's illustrative perception and the "fractured footprint" is a teaching scenario. The slide-4 search and the phone demo are scripted simulations, not live AI; the real AI answers were captured on 4 November 2026.